

Word family: **effective / effectively / effectiveness**

Base word: effective

Related forms: effectively, effectiveness

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / adverb (副詞) / noun (相關形式)

Your sentence:

> “What made it **effective** was that it did not try too hard.”

Meaning in this passage

Meaning: Successful in producing the intended result or achieving its purpose.

繁體中文: 能夠成功產生預期效果、達到原本目的的

中文翻譯:

「令它真正有效、能達到廣告目的的原因，是它沒有過分刻意。」

effective = 能成功產生預期效果、達到目的的

1. **effective = method/product/action (方法／產品／行動) successfully achieving its intended result — 能達到預期效果的; 有效的**

Meaning: Producing the result that was intended.

This is the **main and most common meaning** of **effective**.

Practice 1 — Original

> “What made it **effective** was that it did not try too hard.”

「令它能夠成功達到廣告效果的原因，是它沒有過分刻意。」

Practice 2

> “The new advertising strategy was extremely **effective**.”

「新的廣告策略成功達到預期宣傳效果。」

Practice 3

> “This medicine is **effective** at reducing pain.”

「這種藥物**能有效達到減輕痛楚的作用**。」

effective = 能成功產生預期結果、達到原本目的的

This same core meaning covers many contexts:

* **effective advertisement** → 能成功吸引／說服受眾的廣告

* **effective treatment** → 能成功改善病情的治療

* **effective solution** → 能成功解決問題的方法

* **effective communication** → 能成功讓對方理解並產生所需效果的溝通

These are **not separate meanings**.

2. **effective** = person/worker/leader (人／員工／領導者) good at producing the required results — 做事能達成目標、取得實際成果的

Meaning: Able to perform a role successfully and achieve the results required.

This is still related to #1, but it is useful for learners because **effective** can describe a **person**, not only a method or thing.

Practice 4

> “She is a very **effective** manager.”

「她是一位**很能達成管理目標、取得實際成果的**經理。」

Practice 5

> “An **effective** teacher can explain difficult ideas clearly.”

「一位**能成功達到教學目的的**老師，可以把困難的概念解釋得很清楚。」

effective person = 做事能達成所需目標並取得實際成果的人

3. **effective** = law/rule/agreement/date (法律／規則／協議／日期) officially operating or in force — 正式生效的；開始具有法律或實際效力的

Meaning: Officially in operation or legally valid from a particular time.

This is a **genuinely different meaning** from “successful.”

Practice 6

> “The new policy becomes **effective** on 1 October.”

「新政策將於 10 月 1 日**正式生效**。」

Practice 7

> “The contract is **effective** from the date of signing.”

「合約由簽署日期起**正式具有法律效力**。」

effective = 已正式開始生效、具有法律或制度效力的

Common patterns:

* **effective from + date** = 由某日期起生效

* **effective on + date** = 於某日期生效

* **effective immediately** = 即時生效

4. **effective** = actual/practical amount (實際數值／實際效果) after all relevant factors are considered — 實際的; 把相關因素計算後真正產生的

Meaning: The real or practical amount/result after factors such as fees, compounding, deductions, or adjustments are taken into account.

This is common in finance, business, economics, and technical contexts.

Practice 8

> “The **effective** interest rate is higher than the advertised rate.”

「把複利等因素計算在內後，**實際利率**比宣傳的利率高。」

Practice 9

> “After fees, the **effective** cost of the service is much higher.”

「把各項費用計算在內後，這項服務的**實際成本**高很多。」

****effective amount/rate/cost = 把相關因素全部計算後，實際產生的數值或效果****

5. ****effectively = in a way that successfully achieves the intended result — 以能達到預期效果的方式; 有效地****

****Meaning:**** In a manner that successfully produces the desired result.

Practice 10

> “The advertisement communicated its message ****effectively****.”

「那則廣告****成功而有效地把訊息傳達給受眾****。」

Practice 11

> “She deals with customer complaints very ****effectively****.”

「她處理客戶投訴時，****能成功解決問題並取得所需結果****。」

****effectively = 以能成功達到目的的方式****

6. ****effectively = in practical reality / essentially (實際上等同於某種情況) — 實際上; 等於; 形同****

This is a different and very useful meaning of ****effectively****.

****Meaning:**** In practical terms, even if something is not formally or literally described that way.

Practice 12

> “The company has ****effectively**** stopped operating.”

「這家公司****實際上已經等同停止營運****。」

Practice 13

> “Without internet access, the system is ****effectively**** useless.”

「沒有網絡連接的話，這個系統****實際上等同無法使用****。」

****effectively = 雖然未必正式如此，但實際情況等同於.....****

Compare:

> “She communicates **effectively**.”

> = 她**有效地**溝通。

> “The office is **effectively** closed.”

> = 辦公室**實際上**等同已關閉。

Same spelling, two different adverbial senses.

7. **effectiveness** = degree to which something achieves its intended purpose — 達成預期目的的程度；成效

Here, **effectiveness** is a noun.

Meaning: How successful something is at producing its intended result.

Practice 14

> “We need to measure the **effectiveness** of the advertising campaign.”

「我們需要衡量這次廣告活動**達成宣傳目的的程度／成效**。」

Practice 15

> “The study examined the **effectiveness** of the new treatment.”

「研究檢視了新療法**實際改善病情的成效**。」

effectiveness = 某方法、行動或措施達成預期目的的程度／成效

Important distinction: **effective** vs **efficient**

These are commonly confused.

effective

= achieves the desired result

= **能成功達成目標**

> “The campaign was **effective**.”

「這次宣傳活動**成功達到了目的**。」

efficient

= achieves the result with little wasted time, money, or effort

= **以較少時間、成本或資源完成事情**

> “The new system is more **efficient**.”

「新系統**使用較少時間／資源便能完成工作**。」

Something can be:

* **effective but inefficient**

= 有效, 但耗費很多資源

* **efficient but ineffective**

= 做得很省資源, 但沒有達到真正目標

Important distinction: **effective vs effect**

effective — adjective

> “It is an **effective** advertisement.”

「這是一則**能成功達到宣傳目的的**廣告。」

effect — noun

> “The advertisement had a strong **effect** on me.”

「那則廣告對我產生了很大的**影響／效果**。」

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
effective method/product/action	能成功產生預期結果、達到原本目的的
effective person/leader	做事能達成所需目標並取得實際成果的
effective law/rule/date	已正式開始生效、具有法律或制度效力的

effective rate/cost/amount	把相關因素計算後真正產生的實際數值	
effectively — successfully	以能成功達到預期目的的方式	
effectively — practically	雖未必正式如此, 但實際情況等同於.....	
effectiveness	某方法或措施達成預期目的的程度／成效	

For your original sentence

> “What made it **effective** was that it did not try too hard.”

The exact meaning is:

****effective = 能夠成功產生預期效果、達到原本目的的****

Here, because the subject is an advertisement:

****effective advertisement = 能成功吸引受眾、傳達訊息並達到宣傳目的的廣告****